

Chicago Tribune



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THE TRUMP TRANSITION

Days before Donald Trump’s inauguration, harried resistance efforts underscore ‘a new era in American politics.’ And, as part of that electoral sea change, Chicago’s Latinos are using newfound political capital to make big demands.



Sam Sanchez, owner of Moe’s Cantina, sits at his River North restaurant. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

A renewed coalition

Pro-Trump Latinos start campaign for border security and legal status for essential workers

By Laura Rodríguez Presa
Chicago Tribune

Sam Sanchez, a Chicago-based restaurateur, hadn’t planned to get involved in politics until he realized that his voice was a platform that many of his undocumented employees didn’t have. When recently arrived

migrants from mostly Venezuela received expedited work permits from the Biden administration, he noticed the anger and disappointment that some of his undocumented workers from Mexico — who had been in the country for decades — felt. “A lot of the people that are struggling and who have been

waiting for a job permit for years got passed over and it made a lot of people mad. There’s a lot of resentment and I see my employees struggle,” said Sanchez, who owns Moe’s Cantina and other Chicago restaurants and is on the board of the National Restaurant Association. So Sanchez headed to the White House to advocate for them. “All we wanted was job

Turn to Voice, Page 4

Protests offer chaotic look into defiance

Women’s March rebrands to try reviving fervor of 2017, but turbulence marks Chicago events

By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

Fueled by rage and anxiety following the first inauguration of President Donald Trump, the magnitude of the Women’s Marches of 2017 caught the nation by surprise, marking what was widely believed to be the largest single-day protest event in American history at the time. In Chicago, roughly a quarter-million demonstrators flooded the downtown area, shutting down sections of the Loop. A sea of protesters, many donning the event’s iconic pink knitted “pussy hats,” hoisted signs and chanted “No Trump. No KKK. No fascist USA” as they spilled out of Grant Park. The Chicago rally was held in concert with the Women’s March on Washington and similar protests in cities across the globe, where millions took to the streets to challenge Trump’s agenda on his first full day in office. The Women’s March turned into an annual event, embracing themes of gender equality, bodily autonomy and preservation of civil rights. But a few years later, discord and accusations of antisemitism plagued the national Women’s March leadership, spurring the resignation of several board

members and some fracturing within the broader grassroots movement. Now, ahead of a second Trump presidency, national Women’s March organizers have rebranded their annual January event as “The People’s March,” which includes a coalition of dozens of organizations focused on reproductive rights, racial justice, immigration, environmental conservation and other issues. The marches are scheduled on Saturday — two days before Trump’s second inauguration — in Washington, D.C., and hundreds of other cities, including multiple local events. But it remains to be seen if the protests can come anywhere close to reviving the fervor, support and united front that defined the initial Women’s Marches. The demonstrations and events this weekend will provide an early glimpse at what a potential Trump resistance effort might look like as the Republican president-elect returns to the White House — threatening mass deportations, rollbacks of health care initiatives, a reprisal of the so-called “Muslim travel ban” from his first administration and

Turn to Protests, Page 4

Nominees quizzed on taxes, climate

U.S. Treasury nominee Scott Bessent on Thursday faced questions on tariffs, China and the future of an IRS tax filing system that Republicans have called to be cut, while Environmental Protection Agency pick Lee Zeldin showed ambivalence toward climate science. **Nation & World**

Musicians answer inauguration ‘call’

Country music star Carrie Underwood will perform “America the Beautiful” at Donald Trump’s inauguration next week, and the 1970s disco group the Village People will perform at one of Trump’s inaugural balls and a rally the day before. **Nation & World in Business, Page 5**

Jurors set to hear closing arguments in Madigan case

By Jason Meisner and Megan Crepeau
Chicago Tribune

After nearly three months, more than 60 witnesses and a surprising turn on the stand from the defendant himself, the evidence phase of former House Speaker Michael Madigan’s corruption trial has drawn to a close. Madigan’s attorneys formally rested Thursday morning, followed by a brief rebuttal case from prosecutors, who then also rested. Jurors were set to return Wednesday to begin hearing instructions and closing arguments, which will stretch over at least three days. The trial of Madigan, the former leader of the state Democratic Party, and his co-defendant, longtime confidant Michael McClain, represents the apex of a yearslong federal corruption investigation that has already

Turn to Madigan, Page 2

Israel delays ceasefire vote as airstrikes kill 72 in Gaza

By Tia Goldenberg, Wafaa Shurafa and Samy Magdy
Associated Press

TEL AVIV, Israel — Israel delayed a Cabinet vote Thursday on the long-awaited ceasefire deal that would pause the fighting in the Gaza Strip and release dozens of hostages. Israeli airstrikes, meanwhile, killed at least 72 people in the war-ravaged territory. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu blamed a last-minute dispute with Hamas for holding up the approval as rising tensions in Netanyahu’s government coalition raised concerns about the implementation of the deal just a day after President Joe Biden and key mediator Qatar announced it was complete. That created a dual reality: War-weary Palestinians in Gaza, the relatives of hostages held in the enclave and world leaders all welcomed the

Turn to Ceasefire, Page 9

INSIDE



FIELD OPERATIONS, RIOS

Green light for United Center project

The Chicago Plan Commission on Thursday endorsed the first phase of a plan to remake the Near West Side neighborhood around the United Center. This initial step will include the privately financed construction of a 6,000-seat music hall, a boutique hotel and nearly 10 acres of green space, including play areas for all ages. **Business**

Season 2 of ‘Severance’ more of same

Taking the idea of work-life balance to extremes, the sardonic and surrealist thriller “Severance” on Apple TV+ envisions a dystopian corporate world in which employees have a chip implanted in their brains that keeps them “at work” at all times. But Season 2 repeats the same themes over and over, living on vibes alone. **Review in A+E**

DAVID LYNCH
1946-2025

A dark visionary



David Lynch, the maker of movies beloved for his uniquely dark vision, such as “Blue

Velvet” and “Mulholland Drive,” and the TV series “Twin Peaks,” has died just days before his 79th birthday. **Nation & World in Business, Page 7**

BOB UECKER
1934-2025

‘Mr. Baseball’



Bob Uecker, a Milwaukee native who parlayed a forgettable career as a backup catcher into a punch line for movie and TV appearances and a Hall of Fame tenure as a broadcaster for his hometown Brewers, has died of lung cancer at age 90. **Chicago Sports**

